

Strangler fig Unlike rafflesia, the strangler fig kills its host plant. The seed germinates in a branch crevice high up in a tree. It then grows roots down to the ground, “strangling” the host tree, which withers and dies.



Tarantula hawk wasp This wasp paralyzes a spider with its sting before laying an egg on the spider's abdomen. The wasp larva burrows into the spider and feeds, avoiding vital organs to keep the spider alive for as long as possible.



Growing bud

The threads spread inside the vine for up to 18 months.

At flowering time, a small rafflesia bud bursts through the bark of the vine's woody stem. It may take up to nine months for the bud to fully develop, by which time it resembles a large cabbage.

Rafflesia

Also known as the corpse lily, rafflesia is the world's largest single flower. You can usually smell it before you see it—it reeks like decaying flesh! This amazing plant lives hidden inside forest vines as a parasite. Only when rafflesia flowers can you actually see it.

Living off the vine

A rafflesia seed lodges in the roots or stem of a vine. It germinates and sends out tiny threads to absorb water and nutrients. The vine may be weakened, but it won't die.



Leaves of the host vine